Human rights thus became a vehicle for interest groups to impose controls over others' behavior. They therefore became the weapon of choice for those waging war upon the bedrock values of western culture.

The principal target of this onslaught was the concept of duty towards others. The emergence of a culture of hyper-individualism gave rise to a radical egalitarianism of lifestyles and values. Morality was privatised, and all constraints of religion, tradition, or cultural taboos became viewed as an attack on personal autonomy. No values could take precedence over any other. Liberal society therefore couldn't say that liberal values were superior to illiberal values—which tied it up in knots when presented with Islamic views about freedom of speech, the status of women, or religious dissidents.

The nation itself became suspect, since it was the embodiment of a majority identity which by definition treated minorities as lower in the cultural hierarchy. So the idea of a nation which represents and protects individual citizens on the basis that they all subscribe equally to a set of overarching identity and values came to be replaced as the key political driver by interest groups defined by race, religion, ethnicity, gender, or other existential categories.

The nation state itself came to be seen as past its sell-by date, an anachronism responsible for all the ills of the world such as racism, prejudice, and war. The remedy was what John Fonte termed "transnational progressivism," the idea that what we all must sign up to crosses national boundaries. Democratic politics then began to die.

Laws based on the values, traditions, and histories of particular nation states needed to be replaced by universal laws and delivery mechanisms. So international law trumped the political decisions of sovereign states, and human rights law trumped their values.

These supra-national laws and values were imposed by supra-national institutions such as the European Court of Human Rights, the European Union, the UN, or the International Criminal Court, which increasingly became viewed as the sole sources of legitimacy. Indeed, law itself now trumped other forms of human interaction such as, at one end of the spectrum, informal relationships based on custom or convention and, at the other end, defending liberty through war.

The view took hold that the application of law would settle all the world's problems and conflicts. It was law that by regulating behavior and attitudes would bring about a new and uplifted universal psyche. Codifying principles to which all civilised people could sign up would, it was thought, eradicate hatred, impose global order, and remove any occasion for war. Indeed, law would now trump war.

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